EXPERIMENT 9

Exploring AI-Assisted Features and Built-In Analytics (Zia) in Zoho Creator

Bank Loan Application Form — Dashboard, Formatting & Kanban Analytics Use Case

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Submitted by

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Aim

To explore the AI-assisted and built-in analytics capabilities of Zoho Creator — powered by Zia, Zoho's AI assistant — by reviewing the dashboard, colour-formatted reports, and Kanban-grouped views of the Bank Loan Application Form application, and to understand how these features turn raw form data into actionable visual insight without writing custom code.

Objectives

- To review the application dashboard's summary tiles and charts (loan applications by status, type of document and application date).
- To study how colour formatting on report columns makes key fields stand out so records are easy to scan at a glance.
- To study Kanban report views (status, Type of document) as a built-in way to group and visualise loan applications without any scripting.
- To review the All Loan Applications report as the structured data these analytics are built on.
- To understand Zia's role within Zoho Creator in suggesting chart types, generating dashboard layouts, and surfacing patterns in application data.

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Software / Tools Required

- Zoho Creator (web-based low-code application development platform)
- Bank Loan Application Form application
- Web browser with an active internet connection
- Zoho account with access to the application in Access/Live mode

Introduction / Theory

Built-In Analytics in Zoho Creator

Zoho Creator ships with analytics components that turn form records into visual summaries without any separate BI tool. A Dashboard page can combine summary tiles, pie and bar charts, and embedded reports in one view; individual reports can use colour formatting to highlight rows, cells or columns; and a Kanban report groups records into columns by a chosen field, giving a board-style view of status, category or document type. All of these read live data directly from the application's forms, so the visuals update automatically as records are added or changed.

Zia — Zoho's AI Assistant

Zia is the AI layer built into the Zoho ecosystem, including Creator. Within Creator, Zia-driven features assist application builders by suggesting appropriate chart types for a given report, helping auto-generate dashboard layouts from existing forms, and surfacing trends that would otherwise need manual analysis. Rather than requiring the developer to hand-code every chart, Zia-assisted suggestions speed up the process of turning a plain data table into a meaningful summary.

Key Concepts

Concept	Description
Dashboard	A custom page combining summary tiles, charts, and embedded reports into a single, auto-refreshing overview of application data.
Chart Widget	A visual element (pie, bar, donut, etc.) bound to a report that summarises records by a chosen field, such as status or Type of document.
Conditional Formatting	A report-level rule that colours a cell or row automatically based on its value, making important values (e.g. an application status) stand out without manual review.
Kanban Report	A board-style report that groups records into columns by a selected field (e.g. status, Type of document), letting staff scan records visually.
Zia Insights	AI-assisted suggestions within Zoho Creator that recommend chart types, help assemble dashboard layouts, and highlight patterns in the underlying data.

Application Specifications

Parameter	Detail
Application Name	Bank Loan Application Form
Primary Forms	loan application form (loan applications)
Dashboard Elements	Charts by status, Type of document and application date; Applications pending and Applications rejected summary tiles
Formatted Reports	All Loan Applications (colour applied to the Name, Application date and status columns)
Kanban Reports	Loan_Application_Report grouped by status (Approval Status) and by Type of document
Standard Data Report	All Loan Applications — Name, Email, Phone, Application date, Repayment date, interest rate, status

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Procedure

1. Open the application dashboard

Opening the Bank Loan Application Form application loads its Dashboard, which summarises the loan application data into tiles and charts.



Fig. 9.1 — Dashboard — Summary Tiles and Charts

The dashboard shows donut, pie and bar charts summarising loan applications, along with the Applications pending and Applications rejected summary tiles.

2. Apply colour formatting to the application report

The All Loan Applications report was opened in the report builder and colour was applied to its key columns, so that important fields stand out from the rest of the data.

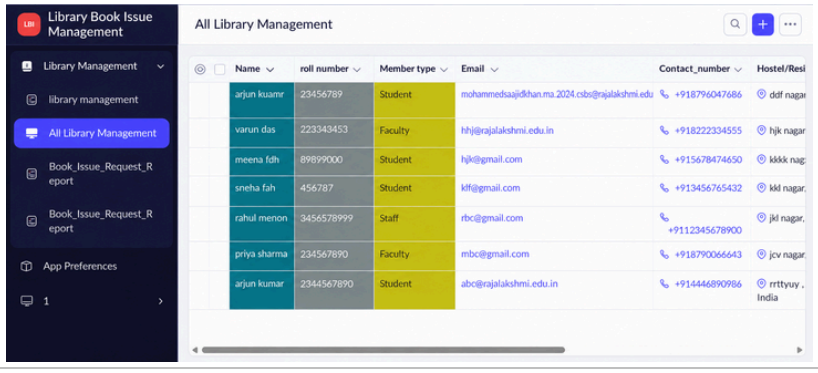


Fig. 9.2 — All Loan Applications — Colour Formatting on Report Columns

The Name, Application date and status columns are shaded in different colours, so the key columns stand out and a reviewer can scan the whole report quickly instead of reading every cell.

3. Switch to the status Kanban view

A Kanban report was opened, grouping the loan applications into columns by their status (Approval Status) field.

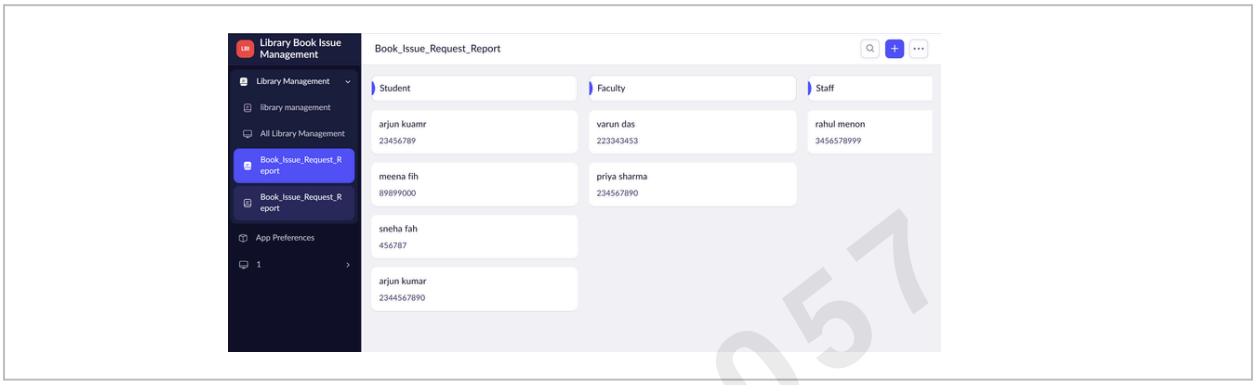


Fig. 9.3 — Loan_Application_Report — Kanban Grouped by Status

The board shows one column per status value, with each application rendered as a card showing the applicant's name, so staff can see at a glance which applications are pending, approved or declined.

4. Switch to the Type of document Kanban view

A second Kanban report was opened, grouping the same applications by the Type of document field.

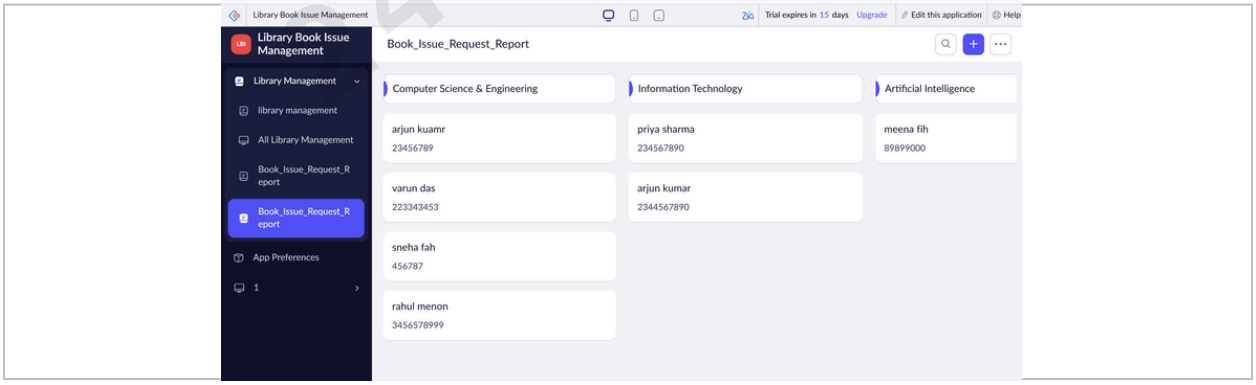


Fig. 9.4 — Loan_Application_Report — Kanban Grouped by Type of Document

Application cards are grouped into columns by the type of document submitted, showing bank staff which documents need to be verified.

5. Review the underlying report data

The All Loan Applications report was opened in its standard view to confirm the structured application data that the dashboard, formatting and Kanban views draw on.

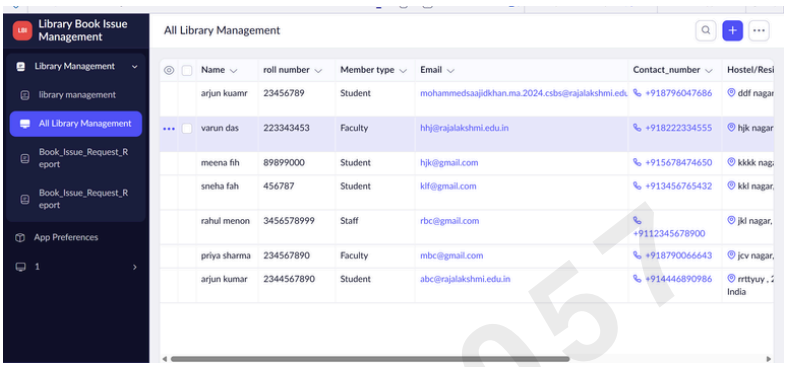


Fig. 9.5 — All Loan Applications — Structured Application Data

The submitted applications are listed with their Name, Email, Phone, Application date, Repayment date, interest rate and status, forming the clean data that the dashboard and Kanban views summarise.

Result

- The Bank Loan Application Form dashboard was reviewed, confirming that it summarises loan applications into live tiles and charts.
- Colour formatting was applied to the All Loan Applications report, making the Name, Application date and status columns stand out.
- Zia's role in suggesting chart types and dashboard layouts was studied alongside the manual report-builder formatting options.
- Two Kanban report views, grouped by status and by Type of document, were reviewed, confirming that applications can be grouped and browsed visually by any chosen field.
- The All Loan Applications report was reviewed as the structured data underlying these analytics.

Conclusion

The experiment demonstrated how Zoho Creator's built-in analytics and Zia-assisted features convert plain loan application records into decision-ready visuals with no custom charting code. The dashboard's tiles and charts give an instant overview of volume and distribution, colour formatting makes key columns easy to scan, and Kanban reports let bank staff browse the same data as a visual board grouped by status or type of document. Zia supports this by suggesting charts and layouts, although some formatting still has to be configured manually in the report builder. Together these features show that low-code analytics in Zoho Creator is a natural extension of the structured forms and reports already built in earlier experiments.

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